

Frequently asked questions

Q. Can I have an orgasm and ejaculate with a penile implant?

A. You should be able to have an orgasm and ejaculate with a penile implant if you were able to ejaculate and orgasm before the implant.⁴² Consult your physician about your expected outcome.

Q. Will a penile implant cause me to lose sensation in my penis?

A. If you had sensation in your penis before receiving the implant, you should have the similar sensation in your penis after the implant.⁴³ The implant and associated surgery is not supposed to change your penis sensation since typically the surgery does not have any negative effects on the nerves in the head of the penis that cause sensations. If you are considering moving forward with penile implant surgery, it is important to find a urologist that has adequate training in men's sexual health and the penile implant procedure and further discuss the risks and benefits of the penile implant procedure.

Q. What is the recovery time?

A. Everyone is different and recovery time varies, but typically it's between 4-6 weeks until you can resume sexual activity.³⁰ Your physician will determine what you can and can't do during this time. It is important to follow all recommendations from your physician for the best outcome.

Q. Will I lose any length after getting a penile implant?

A. Each penile implant is custom fit to your anatomy.⁴³ Like any body part that goes unused for a long time, the muscles and fibers of that body part begin to break down. If it has been a long time since you've achieved a good erection, you may experience some atrophy and perceived penis shortening. Discuss this in greater detail with your physician.

Q. Will anyone notice that I have an implant?

A. The Titan[®] implant is completely placed inside your body and is not visibly noticeable. The penis appears relaxed and normal when in the flaccid state,⁴ and it is not obvious by looking at a man that he has an implant. The Genesis[®] malleable implant stays firm when not in the erect position, and it may "show" through clothes.

Q. How long does the penile implant last?

A. A study showed that estimated overall device survival rates are: 87.2% at 5 years, 76.8% at 10 years, and 63.7% at 15 years.²³

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Q. Will I be able to have spontaneous erections with a penile implant?

A. Both the Titan® and the Genesis® implants give you the ability to have an erection instantly and spontaneously, any time you want one.⁴ However, the implant surgery makes it impossible to ever have a “latent” or natural erection that’s not dependent on the device.³³ Therefore, you should consider carefully whether or not an implant is the right choice for you.

Q. What is the difference between the Genesis and the Titan implants?

A: Both help give you the ability to have an erection satisfactory for intercourse. The main difference is that the Genesis is a flexible (malleable) implant that consists of two firm but bendable rods that are placed into the shaft of the penis (corpora cavernosa). There are no other parts to this implant. To have an erection, you simply hold the penis and move it into the desired position. When you are finished, you return the penis to its tucked-down position. With the Titan implant, you inflate the cylinders by squeezing the pump located in your scrotum to achieve an erection, and deflate by pressing the release valve to return the fluid from the cylinders into the reservoir to return to flaccid state.

Q: Is the cost of a penile implant covered by insurance?

A: A penile implant is prescribed by your physician. Most insurers, including Medicare, cover the implant.³⁴ Check with your physician’s office and your insurance carrier to determine your actual cost.

Q. Will the Titan implant interfere with other equipment (e.g., MRI)?

A: The Titan implant contains metal that can be safely scanned by airport security. The Titan implant is MR-Conditional meaning it can be scanned by a magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) machine when it is used according to MR-Conditional specifications. After surgery you will receive a Patient Implant Card to carry at all times. This card identifies your device as MR-Conditional and provides the specific manufacturing details of your penile implant.⁴

Q: Can I go through airport security with the Titan implant?

A: Yes, the Titan penile implant is safe for standard airport security.

Q: What can I expect after the penile implant procedure?

A: After the penile implant procedure, mild swelling, pain, and discomfort can occur.⁴⁴ Your doctor will advise on when to return to normal activities. Most men can resume strenuous physical activity and sexual activity about 4-6 weeks after the procedure. Sexual activity should not be resumed until approval is received from the implanting physician.⁴⁵

Q: What are the risks of the penile implant?

A: Review the Important Safety Information on pages 42-45 for a full list of risks and potential complications.